SSC CGL / RRB NTPC — GENERAL AWARENESS

Practice Question Bank: January 2026 Current Affairs

10 High-Yield Exam Questions with Solutions

Q1. Which Indian military personnel was conferred with the nation's highest peacetime gallantry award, the Ashok Chakra, in January 2026?

(a) Wing Commander Abhinandan Varthaman
(b) Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla
(c) Major Radhika Sen
(d) Captain Shiva Chouhan

Answer: (b) Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla

Explanation: Designated Gaganyaan astronaut Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla was honoured with the Ashok Chakra for exceptional courage and distinguished service.

Q2. India's first commercial Vande Bharat Sleeper Train was flagged off in January 2026 to connect which two destinations?

(a) New Delhi to Patna
(b) Kolkata (Howrah) to Guwahati
(c) Mumbai to Ahmedabad
(d) Bengaluru to Chennai

Answer: (b) Kolkata (Howrah) to Guwahati

Explanation: Indian Railways launched its first long-distance Vande Bharat Sleeper train on the Kolkata–Guwahati corridor, designed for overnight passenger transit.

Q3. What is the name of the official interactive mascot launched by the Unique Identification Authority of India (UIDAI) in January 2026?

(a) Aadhaar Sathi
(b) Udai
(c) Sugam
(d) Setu

Answer: (b) Udai

Explanation: UIDAI launched "Udai", an animated interactive chatbot and service mascot to streamline citizen query resolution and digital literacy around Aadhaar.

Q4. In January 2026, which country announced its formal withdrawal from the World Health Organization (WHO)?

(a) Russia
(b) United Kingdom
(c) United States
(d) Argentina

Answer: (c) United States

Explanation: The United States government officially finalized its geopolitical withdrawal process from the World Health Organization (WHO).

Q5. Who took charge as the Vice Chief of the Air Staff (VCAS) of the Indian Air Force on January 1, 2026?

(a) Air Marshal Amar Preet Singh
(b) Air Marshal Narmdeshwar Tiwari
(c) Air Marshal Sujeet Pushpakar Dharkar
(d) Air Marshal Ashutosh Dixit

Answer: (b) Air Marshal Narmdeshwar Tiwari
Explanation: Air Marshal Narmdeshwar Tiwari assumed the office of Vice Chief of the Air Staff (VCAS) succeeding his predecessor at Air Headquarters.

Q6. In January 2026, which wetland was officially notified as India's 101st Ramsar Site of international importance?

(a) Ansupa Lake (Odisha)
(b) Glaw Lake (Arunachal Pradesh)
(c) Pala Wetland (Mizoram)
(d) Shallbugh Wetland (Jammu & Kashmir)

Answer: (b) Glaw Lake (Arunachal Pradesh)
Explanation: Glaw Lake, situated inside the Kamlang Wildlife Sanctuary in Arunachal Pradesh, received global recognition as India expanded its network to 101 Ramsar sites.

Q7. The trilateral naval Exercise 'Dosti-17', which began in January 2026, involves India along with which two other nations?

(a) Maldives and Sri Lanka
(b) Mauritius and Seychelles
(c) Bangladesh and Myanmar
(d) Indonesia and Thailand

Answer: (a) Maldives and Sri Lanka
Explanation: Exercise Dosti is a biennial trilateral coast guard exercise conducted between India, Maldives, and Sri Lanka to bolster maritime safety and interoperability.

Q8. What was India's rank on the Henley Passport Index released in January 2026?

(a) 75th
(b) 80th
(c) 85th
(d) 92nd

Answer: (b) 80th
Explanation: The Henley Passport Index evaluated global visa-free mobility, placing the Indian passport at 80th rank with visa-free access to 57 destinations.

Q9. Who won the Women's Singles title at the Australian Open 2026?

(a) Aryna Sabalenka
(b) Iga Świątek
(c) Elena Rybakina
(d) Coco Gauff

Answer: (c) Elena Rybakina

Explanation: Kazakhstan's Elena Rybakina defeated Aryna Sabalenka in the women's singles final at Melbourne Park to claim her major Grand Slam title.

Q10. Former Indian diplomat Navtej Sarna was conferred the Sahitya Akademi Award 2025 (announced/awarded January 2026) in the English language category for which book?

(a) The Exile
(b) Crimson Spring
(c) Zafarnama
(d) The Book of Nanak

Answer: (b) Crimson Spring

Explanation: Navtej Sarna received the award for his historical novel *Crimson Spring*, based on the 1919 Jallianwala Bagh massacre and its aftermath.